

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Master Direction Report

Five Pillars, One Table, One Number — Updated & Re-verified September 16, 2026 (light daily touch) · COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED

*This is a light daily touch (score set **2026-09-16 draft**, committed, auto-stamped) against yesterday's light daily touch (2026-09-15_draft, committed). **CLARITY Act RE-RATED DOWN** (37/53/62/83/92 → 15/28/45/72/92) — the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture vote on the motion to proceed to H.R. 3633 FAILED 49-50. **Iran War Risk RE-RATED DOWN modestly** on the 6/12/36mo windows (1/1/18/38/70 → 1/1/14/33/66) on an IAEA UN Security Council referral and a 130-lawmaker NPT-withdrawal push. Tokenization RWA and Fed & Macro both held flat; the FOMC decision (2:00pm ET today) had not landed at run time.*

THE FINAL NUMBER · SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 · EQUAL-WEIGHT MODEL (COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED)

-0.05

Neutral overall — down modestly from yesterday's -0.01 as the Fed & Macro pillar re-rates down on the FOMC's hawkish dot plot; no call-band flip on the headline number. Equal-weight mean of the five master window signals (scale -10 to +10; horizon-weighted variant +0.53, versus yesterday's +0.56, still Mild Bull).

COINPICKS MASTER BLEND · ALL FIVE PILLARS EQUAL-WEIGHTED · 20% EACH

Compiled September 17, 2026 (light daily touch, committed, auto-stamped) · BTC \$76,197.81 (data refreshed via GitHub Actions, September 17, 2026) · Engine: engine/blend.py — run.py blend (equal-weight, 2026-09-17_draft, committed; prior set: 2026-09-16_draft, committed) · Not Financial Advice

The Master Table

The whole thesis in five rows, on the September 17 light daily touch (2026-09-17_draft, committed, auto-stamped) vs. yesterday's light daily touch (2026-09-16_draft, committed). Signals on the -10 to +10 scale.

WINDOW	MASTER (EQUAL-WT)	YESTERDAY'S MASTER (SEPT 16 TOUCH)	THE CALL
1 month	-2.13	-2.03	Bear — Fed & Macro's P drops 34 → 32 on the FOMC's hawkish dot plot; CLARITY (-4.76) and Iran (-4.70) stay pinned near their floors; the worst window this cycle
3 months	-1.76	-1.71	Bear — Fed & Macro eases further (-2.31 → -2.58) on the same hawkish forward guidance; CLARITY (-2.99) and Iran (-5.10) hold flat
6 months	-0.55	-0.50	Mild Bear — Fed & Macro eases slightly (-0.77 → -1.02); CLARITY (-0.68) and Iran (-4.03) hold flat, Tokenization (+2.18) and Bitcoin TA (+0.79) partly offset
1 year	+1.34	+1.34	Mild Bull — unchanged; four of five pillars still positive, Iran (-1.77) alone negative here
3 years	+2.85	+2.85	Bull — law + adoption + cycle + value; unchanged, every pillar still positive

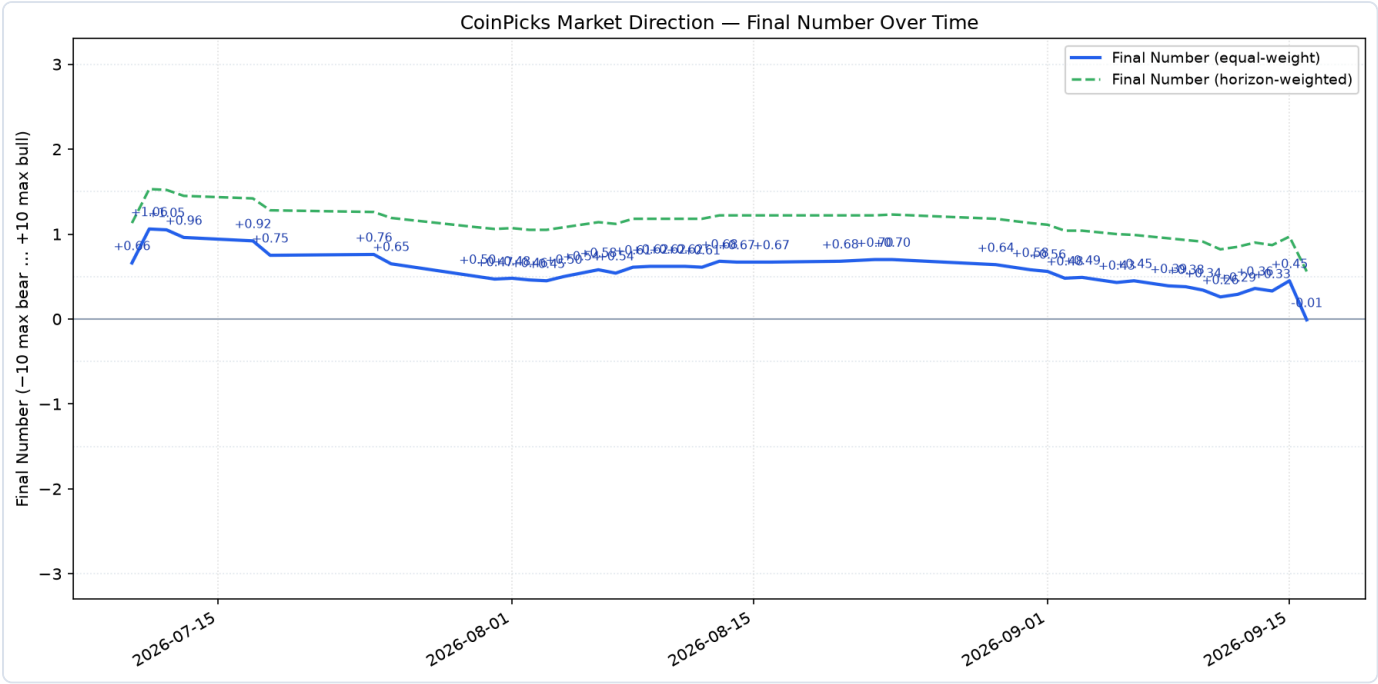
Formula: per pillar, $\text{Signal} = ((P - 50) \div 50) \times \text{Quality} \times \text{Impact}$, with Impact a uniform **8** for every pillar. **MASTER = the simple mean of all five pillar signals** — equal weight, 20% each (add a pillar and it auto-rebalances to 1/N). Bands: $|s| < 0.5$ Neutral · < 1.5 Mild · < 3 Bull/Bear · < 5 Strong · else Very Strong. Machine-verified two ways (hand recompute of every pillar signal and every master window, cross-checked against run.py blend's own output).

THE FINAL NUMBER — HOW IT'S BUILT, AND WHAT MOVED THIS CYCLE

-0.05 = the equal-weight mean of the five MASTER signals above $((-2.13 - 1.76 - 0.55 + 1.34 + 2.85) \div 5)$. Weighting the longer windows harder (10/15/20/30/25%) gives **+0.53**, still Mild Bull. **What moved:** one pillar. Fed & Macro re-rated DOWN on the near/mid windows (34/33/44/54/60 → 32/31/42/54/60) once the Sept 16 FOMC hiked 25bp to 3.75%-4.00% (largely priced, not scored alone) and its SEP/dot plot showed 16 of 18 officials expecting another 2026 hike — new primary Fed forward guidance beyond what market odds had already priced. CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk, and Tokenization all held flat; the computed Bitcoin TA pillar eased slightly on the cycle-analog clock (1mo +0.96, from +1.20) even as price ticked up to \$76,197.81.

The Trend — Final Number, Cycle by Cycle

Every committed reading of THE FINAL NUMBER, in sequence — the record of how the call has actually moved, not just where it sits today. (Today's reading joins this history once archived.)



Generated by engine/history.py from every committed master_blend snapshot in reports/archive/. Rebuilt automatically on every run.py archive (or manually via run.py history).

The Full Pillar Matrix

Every pillar's signal on every window — September 17 light daily touch (2026-09-17_draft), COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED. Each pillar report shows its own full score lineage.

PILLAR (WEIGHT · IMPACT)	1 MO	3 MO	6 MO	1 YR	3 YR	STATUS
CLARITY Act (20% · 8)	-4.76	-2.99	-0.68	+3.17	+6.38	Held flat — no new dated development since the Sept 15 cloture-vote failure; lame-duck speculation already priced
Iran War Risk (20% · 8)	-4.70	-5.10	-4.03	-1.77	+1.41	Held flat — no new development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT statement already priced
Tokenization RWA (20% · 8)	+0.29	+1.41	+2.18	+3.00	+3.92	Held flat — Aave's Sept 16 RWA-hub announcement is single-product continuation, doesn't clear the bar
Fed & Macro (20% · 8)	-2.45	-2.58	-1.02	+0.48	+1.04	RE-RATED DOWN — Sept 16 FOMC hiked 25bp (priced) but its SEP/dot plot's hawkish forward guidance (16/18 officials expect another 2026 hike) is new primary information
Bitcoin TA — quant (20% · 8)	+0.96	+0.45	+0.79	+1.82	+1.52	Eased slightly on the cycle-analog clock — weekly composite +29.6 (completed-bars +31.3), P 58/54/59/69/69; BTC \$76,197.81
MASTER — mean of the five	-2.13	-1.76	-0.55	+1.34	+2.85	equal-wt

P lineage (June → Jul 8 → ... → Sept 15 → Sept 16) — CLARITY 55/60/65/85/92 → ... → 37/53/62/83/92 (Sept 15, re-rated up on the ethics concession) → **15/28/45/72/92** (Sept 16, RE-RATED DOWN on the failed cloture vote; Sept 17, held flat, committed, auto-stamped). Iran War Risk 50/55/62/75/85 → ... → 1/1/18/38/70 (Sept 14-15, held flat) → **1/1/14/33/66** (Sept 16, RE-RATED DOWN on 6/12/36mo; Sept 17, held flat). Tokenization 53/57/62/72/85 → ... → 52/60/66/74/85 (held flat). Fed & Macro 38/40/46/54/61 → ... → 34/33/44/54/60 (Sept 11-16) → **32/31/42/54/60** (Sept 17, RE-RATED DOWN on the FOMC's hawkish dot plot). Bitcoin TA is computed every run: 60/54/59/69/69 (Sept 16) → **58/54/59/69/69** (Sept 17). Each pillar report carries its own full, column-by-column lineage table.

The Story, Window by Window

What the blend is saying on September 17, 2026, a light daily touch (comparisons below are vs. yesterday's light daily touch, 2026-09-16_draft, committed)

- 1 month — Bear (-2.13, down from -2.03). Fed & Macro eased to -2.45 from -2.18** as its P went 34 → 32 on the FOMC's hawkish dot plot; CLARITY (-4.76) and Iran (-4.70) hold flat near their floors; Bitcoin TA eased slightly (+0.96, from +1.20). The worst window this cycle.
- 3 months — Bear (-1.76, down from -1.71). Fed & Macro eased to -2.58 from -2.31** (P 33 → 31) on the same hawkish forward guidance. CLARITY (-2.99), Iran (-5.10) and Tokenization (+1.41) held flat; Bitcoin TA held (+0.45).
- 6 months — Mild Bear (-0.55, down from -0.50). Fed & Macro eased to -1.02 from -0.77** (P 44 → 42). CLARITY (-0.68) and Iran (-4.03) held flat; Tokenization (+2.18) and Bitcoin TA (+0.79) partly offset.
- 1 year — Mild Bull (+1.34, unchanged).** Four of five pillars still positive: CLARITY +3.17, Tokenization +3.00, Bitcoin TA +1.82, Fed +0.48 (unchanged). **Iran (-1.77) is the only negative.**
- 3 years — Bull (+2.85, unchanged).** Every pillar still positive: CLARITY +6.38, Tokenization +3.92, Iran +1.41, Bitcoin TA +1.52, Fed +1.04 (unchanged) — a single FOMC meeting doesn't move a multi-year read.

Where the Two Lenses Agree — and Where They Fight

The point of running qualitative and quantitative on the same standard

THE INDEPENDENT CONFIRMATION

Fed & Macro (judged) re-rates DOWN while Bitcoin TA (computed) barely moves — the tape is the calm lens today: the FOMC's hawkish dot plot is a news-driven event, while the TA pillar's P moved only two points at 1mo (60 → 58) on ordinary cycle-analog drift. That's the structure doing its job: a qualitative shock doesn't spill into the pure-math read, because the tape doesn't know why the Fed hiked, only that price barely moved on it. Consistent with the market's own muted reaction to a largely-priced decision.

THE REAL DISAGREEMENT

Near-term: Bitcoin TA (P 58) is now the strongest near-term pillar; Tokenization (P 52) sits next; Fed & Macro (P 32) and Iran (P 1) sit well below, and CLARITY (P 15) remains one of the two weakest near-term reads. The master resolves it honestly: Bear at 1 month and 3 months, as three pillars drag the same direction at once.

Long-term: the four story pillars average about +3.19 at 3 years (CLARITY +6.38, Tokenization +3.92, Fed +1.04, Iran +1.41) versus the Bitcoin-TA pillar's +1.52 — still roughly 2.1× higher. Remember why: the TA pillar is capped by construction (P never leaves 25–75) and its 3-year Quality is 0.50. Equal weight lets that gap show through honestly instead of burying it in a blend.

Trigger Watch — The Next Six Weeks, Re-Dated

A light daily touch ran today. One trigger fired: the Sept 16 FOMC decision and its SEP/dot plot. CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk, and Tokenization held flat. These are the forward triggers; each pillar report carries the full table.

DATE / LEVEL	EVENT	RE-RATES
FIRED & RESOLVED — Sept 16, 2026, 2:00pm ET, CONFIRMED via federalreserve.gov (primary) plus 5+ independent outlets	The FOMC raised the federal funds target range 25bp to 3.75%-4.00% (12-0 vote), the first hike in three years — largely priced (~92.5% CME odds pre-meeting), not scored alone. The SEP/dot plot showed 16 of 18 officials expecting another 2026 hike, 12 of 18 pencilling in one more 25bp move by year-end; a slower 2027-2028 descent is projected. Bitcoin's reaction was muted (~\$76,300 → drifted back near \$76,000-198)	Fed & Macro: the sole driver of this cycle's move — 34/33/44/54/60 → 32/31/42/54/60 (1mo/3mo/6mo down, 12mo/36mo held). The dot plot's forward guidance, not the hike itself, is the new information
Checked Sept 17, no fresh catalyst	CLARITY Act: no new dated development since the Sept 15 cloture-vote failure; lame-duck speculation already priced	Held flat at 15/28/45/72/92
Checked Sept 17, no fresh catalyst	Iran War Risk: no new development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT statement already priced; Pezeshkian's no-nukes stance unchanged	Held flat at 1/1/14/33/66
Checked Sept 17, no fresh catalyst	Tokenization: Aave's Sept 16 RWA-lending-hub announcement (Avalanche/USAT) is single-product continuation, doesn't clear the bar; no rail failure, depeg, or counterparty default	Held flat at 52/60/66/74/85

~Aug 31, now passed	Historical average cycle-bottom month has passed (cycle month now 28.94)	TA: higher low after this + improving momentum = basin, not cliff
Power-law fair value \$140,453	BTC \$76,197.81 sits ~46% below fair value	1yr/3yr windows: the structural bull case's core, essentially unmoved by this cycle's news

The master flip line — Iran's strikes clause fired Aug 30, escalated sharply Sept 1-2, and the Brent >\$100 clause fired Sept 10-11 and continues to hold: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper, independent confirmation the conflict has widened to a further new state, or a sustained Brent close above \$100. Two of the four clauses are still live. **A new, distinct nuclear-track escalation is now in view but has not itself fired a clause:** an actual NPT withdrawal filing, or a UNSC resolution/sanctions snapback, would be a fresh downside trigger for Iran; Pezeshkian's no-nukes line holding and no parliamentary vote materializing would support reversing part of this cycle's move. **On CLARITY, the flip line fired on the downside Sept 16** — cloture failed cleanly with no released next-step plan. A renewed floor vote that actually passes cloture would be the equivalent upside flip. **On Fed & Macro, the flip line is a durable dovish or hawkish reaction function** — a genuinely dovish Fed pivot (a cut, or explicit forward guidance toward one) would be the upside flip; a second consecutive hike confirming the dot plot's path would deepen this cycle's cut. The TA flip line (weekly close under \$50,000) remains unchanged and is now far from current price.

Robustness — Does Any One Pillar Drive the Call?

Equal weight is now the fixed model — there is no qual/quant mix knob to tune. The test that matters instead: drop any single pillar and see whether the conclusion holds.

— drop CLARITY Act	-0.12	Neutral
— drop Iran War Risk	+0.65	Mild Bull · yes
— drop Tokenization RWA	-0.60	Mild Bear · yes
— drop Fed & Macro	+0.16	Neutral
— drop Bitcoin TA	-0.34	Neutral
all five in (headline)	-0.05	Neutral

Leave-one-out final (drop any one pillar): -0.60 to +0.65 — SIGN STILL FLIPS (fragile). Dropping Tokenization takes the final number to -0.60 (Mild Bear); dropping Iran takes it to +0.65 (Mild Bull). The headline -0.05 is a genuinely balanced blend, not one pillar wearing a crown — read the sign as “roughly flat,” and read the *windows* rather than the headline.

My Decision

COMMITTED — SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 (2026-09-17_draft) · LIGHT DAILY TOUCH · AUTO-STAMPED

MASTER: -2.13 / -1.76 / -0.55 / +1.34 / +2.85 · THE FINAL NUMBER: -0.05 equal-weight (Neutral) / +0.53 horizon-weighted (Mild Bull) · Leave-one-out range: -0.60 to +0.65 · Score set 2026-09-17_draft, COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED · BTC \$76,197.81

This is a light daily touch (2026-09-17_draft) against yesterday's light daily touch (2026-09-16_draft, committed). One pillar moved. **Fed & Macro re-rated DOWN**, 34/33/44/54/60 → 32/31/42/54/60, on the near/mid windows. The Sept 16 FOMC raised the federal funds target range 25bp to 3.75%-4.00% (12-0), and its SEP/dot plot showed 16 of 18 officials expecting another 2026 hike (12 of 18 pencilling in one more 25bp move by year-end). CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk, and Tokenization RWA all held flat.

Why the hike itself doesn't move P, but the dot plot does. The 25bp hike was ~92.5% priced into CME/market odds ahead of the meeting per multiple outlets — under the house sufficiency rule, a market-price-implied outcome materializing is not by itself a fresh primary fact. The SEP/dot plot is different: it's a Fed institutional document, not a market price, and it reveals forward guidance — 16 of 18 officials expecting at least one more hike, a slower 2027-2028 descent than previously projected, and the long-run neutral-rate dots clustering tightly at 3.0%. That's genuinely new information beyond what odds-tracking alone had captured.

Why the move is concentrated on 1mo/3mo/6mo, not 12mo/36mo. The confirmed additional-hike path runs through year-end 2026 into Q1 2027 — squarely inside the windows that moved. The SEP's own longer-run dots (slow descent into 2027-2028, neutral rate near 3.0%) are broadly consistent with what this pillar already carried, so the 12mo/36mo windows held flat.

Stamp decision: AUTO-STAMPED. This is an ordinary light daily touch, not a weekly refresh; research capability (WebSearch fully available; no WebFetch needed) was fully available; and verification came back clean. Per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority as widened September 2, 2026, the size of a move is not a reason to withhold the stamp — the sourcing and sufficiency rules are the safeguard, and they were met. Status set to committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."

What to watch next, in order: (1) whether the market's next repricing tracks the SEP's projected year-end hike, or fades it; (2) whether Iran's parliament actually advances an NPT-withdrawal bill, or Pezeshkian's no-nukes line holds; (3) any signal on a CLARITY lame-duck attempt once the midterms clear the calendar.

Read as an investment posture: don't extrapolate the 1mo/3mo Bear calls into the 1yr/3yr Bull calls, which didn't move; the levels and dates that would change this are printed above — Tokenization is now the largest single swing pillar on the downside (see Robustness above: dropping it alone puts the reading at -0.60, Mild Bear), with Iran the largest on the upside (dropping it alone gives +0.65); the leave-one-out range this cycle (-0.60 to +0.65) still crosses zero — the sign flips depending on which pillar is dropped — a genuinely fragile reading worth watching.

Sources

Each pillar report carries its full, freshly-checked source list. The master adds the engine and headline references for this September 17 light daily touch.

- **The pillars:** the sibling reports in this folder — CoinPicks_Fed_Macro (re-rated DOWN Sept 17) / CLARITY_Act / Iran_War / Tokenization_RWA Pillar Reports (all held flat, re-checked Sept 17) and the computed Bitcoin TA Quant Pillar Report.
- **The engine:** engine/blend.py → data/master_blend.json (score set 2026-09-17_draft in config/scores.json, status: committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)", active_qual_set; full lineage back to 2026-06-19_committed; final-number window weights in config/settings.json "final_weights") · engine/mapping.py → data/pillar_scores.json (data through Sept 17, 2026).
- **September 17 light daily touch — the load-bearing new facts:** [CNBC — Fed rate decision September 2026: rates rise to 3.75%-4%](#) · [Coinpedia — Fed hikes rates 25bps for first time in 3 years, Bitcoin holds \\$76K](#) · [Advisor Perspectives — Fed's](#)

Interest Rate Decision: September 16, 2026 · [CoinGape](#) — [FOMC Meeting 2026 live updates Sept 16](#).

- **Price:** BTC/USD \$76,197.81 (Sept 17, 2026, [data/btc_usd_daily.csv](#) via the [GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow](#)) — up from \$76,013.81 (Sept 16); cycle low \$58,526 close (June 30, 2026).